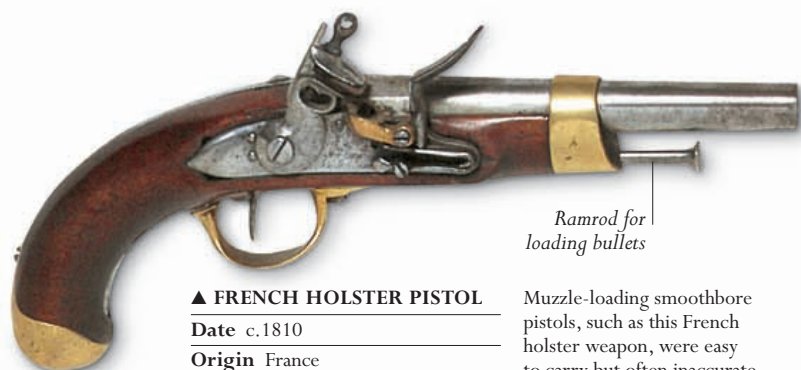




▲ FRENCH HOLSTER PISTOL

Date c.1810

Origin France

Muzzle-loading smoothbore pistols, such as this French holster weapon, were easy to carry but often inaccurate and unreliable.

Ramrod for loading bullets



▲ NEW LAND-PATTERN 1802

Date 1810

Origin UK

Weight 500g (17½oz)

Barrel 23cm (9in)

Calibre .65in

The British Army's New Land-Pattern pistol, first introduced in 1802, was a competent, sturdy design that remained in service until flintlocks gave way to percussion in the 1840s. A version with a flat butt and lanyard ring was produced for the cavalry.



▲ HEAVY CAVALRY TROOPER'S SWORD PATTERN 1796

Date 1796

Origin UK

Weight 1.13kg (2½lb)

Length 1.01m (3¼ft)

British heavy cavalry used the stirrup-hilt British Heavy Cavalry Sword of 1796 in the Napoleonic Wars. They criticized it for being unwieldy, but it was a forceful cutting sword.

Pierced disc hilt

Long langets

Heavy blade with hatchet point



▲ LIGHT CAVALRY TROOPER'S SWORD PATTERN 1796

Date c.1800

Origin UK

Weight 1kg (2¼lb)

Length 96.5cm (38in)

This British light cavalry sword had a heavy blade that broadened towards the tip. This added power at the point of impact – a single blow could sever an arm or split a skull.

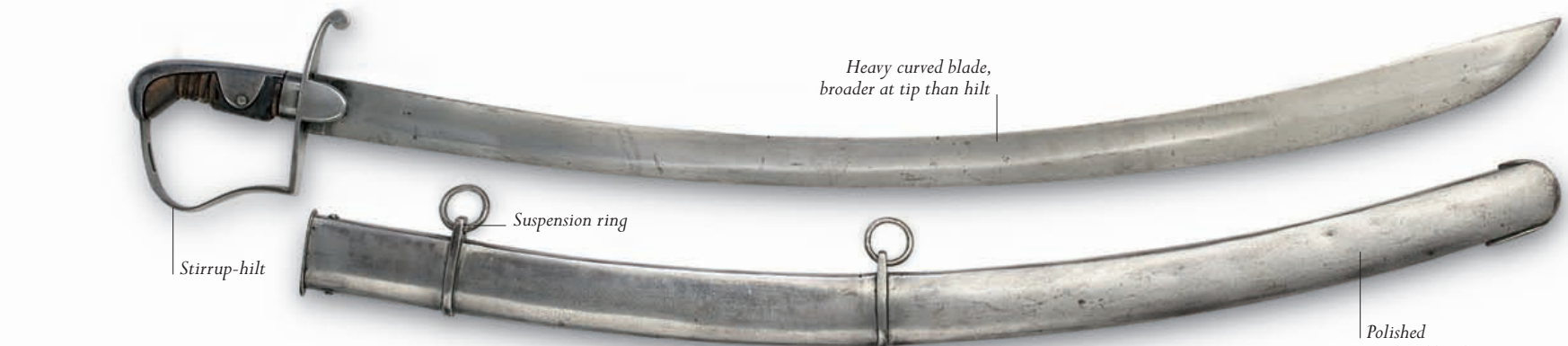
Ramrod

Heavy curved blade, broader at tip than hilt

Suspension ring

Stirrup-hilt

Polished steel scabbard



▼ FRENCH CAVALRY SABRE

Date 1802

Origin France

Weight 1kg (2¼lb)

Length 1m (3¼ft)

French cavalry sabres had narrower blades than their British counterparts. The iron scabbard was tougher than earlier brass and leather examples.



Scabbard